

Pre-Lecture Analysis Sheet

Week 6 · Diagnosis by Observation (Inspection) — 望診
Prof. Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

TCM for Ballroom Dancers | Dance Medicine Specialty

How to use this sheet:
Before lecture → complete Sections A–D and the pre-lecture case questions. Rate your confidence honestly.
During lecture → annotate directly — add answers, corrections, and new insights in the lined spaces.
After lecture → complete Section F, update confidence ratings, and finish the clinical case.

EAM310

Week 6

Summer 2026

A • Learning Targets — I Can Statements

Rate your confidence **before** lecture (Pre) and **after** lecture (Post) by circling a number 1–5 in each column. 1 = can't do it yet · 5 = fully confident

I Can Statement	Pre-Lecture Confidence	Post-Lecture Confidence
Explain the Zang-Xiang (藏象) theory and why internal organ conditions manifest on the body's exterior.	Pre ① ② ③ ④ ⑤	Post ① ② ③ ④ ⑤
Describe observation of Vitality (Shen 神) and distinguish a healthy, vigorous mental status from a lethargic one.	Pre ① ② ③ ④ ⑤	Post ① ② ③ ④ ⑤
Identify the five facial colors and state the excess- vs. deficiency-type pattern each color indicates.	Pre ① ② ③ ④ ⑤	Post ① ② ③ ④ ⑤
Interpret observation of body appearance — shape, movement, and posture — as clinical evidence of underlying patterns.	Pre ① ② ③ ④ ⑤	Post ① ② ③ ④ ⑤
Correlate each of the five sense organs with its associated zang-fu organ and interpret abnormal findings at each.	Pre ① ② ③ ④ ⑤	Post ① ② ③ ④ ⑤
Apply the TCM Four Diagnostic Methods framework and explain why the four must be combined, not used in isolation.	Pre ① ② ③ ④ ⑤	Post ① ② ③ ④ ⑤

B • Activate — Connect to What You Know

B1 • From Midterm to Today

Weeks 1–4 built the foundation — Vital Substances, the Eight Principles, and two palpation/observation skills you already practice: **pulse** and **tongue** diagnosis. The Week 5 midterm reviewed all of it together. Today opens the second unit of the course: the full **TCM Four Diagnostic Methods** (四诊), starting with **Inspection/Observation** (望诊) — the pillar that tongue diagnosis actually belongs to.

What do you already know about Zang-Xiang theory and how internal organs manifest externally? Write whatever comes to mind:

B2 • Connect the Dots

How might each of these prior concepts relate to today's material? Complete the connections:

Tongue diagnosis (Week 4) → Which of the Four Diagnostic Methods does it belong to? What other observations complete that same pillar?	Blood deficiency (Week 1) → What facial color and lip color would you expect to observe, and why?
Heat Excess pattern (Week 2, Eight Principles) → What facial color and complexion quality would confirm this on observation?	Pulse diagnosis (Week 3) → If a patient's pulse and facial color seem to disagree, which diagnostic principle from today explains how to resolve that?

C · Vocabulary Pre-Load — Define Before Class

Fill in your definition/mnemonic before lecture. Refine it during and after class. Blank = opportunity to learn it live.

Character	Pinyin	English	My Definition / Clinical Note
望诊 Wàng Zhěn	Wàng Zhěn	Diagnosis by Observation	
神 Shén	Shén	Spirit / Vitality	
藏象 Zàng Xiàng	Zàng Xiàng	Visceral Manifestation theory	
得神 Dé Shén	Dé Shén	"Having Spirit" — good prognosis	
失神 Shī Shén	Shī Shén	"Loss of Spirit" — poor prognosis	
五色诊 Wǔ Sè Zhěn	Wǔ Sè Zhěn	Five-Color Diagnosis	
面色 Miàn Sè	Miàn Sè	Facial complexion	
四诊 Sì Zhěn	Sì Zhěn	The Four Diagnostic Methods	
闻诊 Wén Zhěn	Wén Zhěn	Listening & Smelling	
问诊 Wèn Zhěn	Wèn Zhěn	Inquiry	
切诊 Qiè Zhěn	Qiè Zhěn	Palpation	

D · Anticipatory Questions — Answer During Lecture

These questions preview exactly what the lecture will teach. Leave blank before lecture — fill in the answers as the material is covered. Come back and expand after class.

Foundations of Observation

Q1 · ZANG-XIANG THEORY

What is Zang-Xiang (藏象) theory, and which classical source states that "viscera inside the body must manifest themselves externally"?

Hint: Lecture slide 20.

Q2 · THE FOUR METHODS

Name the Four Diagnostic Methods (四诊) and explain why relying on only one while neglecting the others is considered one-sided.

Hint: Lecture slides 19, 21–22.

Observation of Vitality (Shen 神)

Q3 · VIGOROUS VS. LETHARGIC SHEN ★

What signs distinguish a "healthy, vigorous" mental status from a "lethargic" one during observation of Vitality? Why does this matter for prognosis?

Hint: Lecture slides 26–27.

Observation of Color — The Five Colors 五色

Q4 · THE FIVE COLORS TABLE ★

Fill in the excess-type vs. deficiency-type indication for each facial color as the lecture covers it:

Color	Excess-Type Indication	Deficiency-Type Indication
Red		
Pale (White)		
Yellow		
Blue (Green)		
Dark Grey (Black)		

Hint: Lecture slides 34–43. This mirrors the homework assignment on slide 57 — get a head start here.

Q5 · BRIGHT WHITE VS. WITHERED PALE

A "bright white, puffy/bloated" face and a "withered pale" face are both in the Pale category — but they point to different patterns. What is each, and how do they differ?

Hint: Lecture slide 36.

Q6 · YANG JAUNDICE VS. YIN JAUNDICE

Distinguish Yang jaundice from Yin jaundice by color quality (bright orange vs. smoky dark) and underlying cause.

Hint: Lecture slide 38.

Q7 · BLUE-PURPLISH FACE, TWO PRESENTATIONS

A blue-purplish face with intermittent chest pain has one interpretation. The same color in a child with high fever and violent limb movement has another. What is each?

Hint: Lecture slide 40.

Observation of Appearance

Q8 · OVERWEIGHT VS. THIN

An overweight patient with mental depression suggests one pattern; a thin patient with dry skin suggests another. What is each, and what do they share as a diagnostic principle?

Hint: Lecture slide 45.

Clinical connection — ballroom & American Rhythm: *Observation of posture and movement quality applies directly on the floor. A Cha Cha or Mambo dancer whose usually crisp hip action turns heavy and effortful, or a Rumba dancer whose extension collapses early, is showing an appearance-based sign worth inspecting before assuming simple fatigue.*

Q9 · WEI, BI, AND WIND STROKE

Compare Wei syndrome, Bi syndrome, and hemiplegia/wind stroke as appearance-based diagnostic categories. What distinguishes each on observation of movement?

Hint: Lecture slide 46.

Observation of the Five Sense Organs

Q10 · ORGAN-TO-ZANG MATCHING ★

Match each sense organ to its associated zang organ, and record one abnormal finding taught for each:

Sense Organ	Associated Zang	One Abnormal Finding
Eye		
Nose		
Ear		
Gums	(Yangming channel)	
Lips & Mouth		
Throat		

Hint: Lecture slides 47–56.

E · Clinical Case — Apply It Before & After

Case Vignette: Ms. Chen, 52 years old

Ms. Chen presents to the clinic having lost **noticeable weight over the past three months**. She appears **withered**, moves slowly, and answers questions with a **dull, delayed** response — her eyes lack luster and rarely meet yours. Her **complexion is a pale yellow, without brightness**. Her **lips are pale**. Her skin appears **dry**. She denies pain. Nasal discharge is clear. Her family reports she "just doesn't seem like herself" and has grown quiet and withdrawn.

- Weight loss, 3 mo.
- Withered appearance
- Dull, delayed responses
- Complexion: pale yellow, no brightness
- Lips: pale
- Skin: dry

Dance medicine parallel: *a similar picture — pale, dull complexion, pale lips, dry skin, low affect — can appear in a Bolero or East Coast Swing dancer mid-competition-season after prolonged rehearsal load without adequate recovery. Inspection findings, not the training log alone, tell you whether this is Blood deficiency.*

Pre-Lecture Questions — Answer Based on Your Current Knowledge

Before the lecture, do your best with these. Guessing is fine — it primes your brain to receive the lecture material.

PRE · Q1

Based on her mental responsiveness alone, would you describe Ms. Chen's Shen as more consistent with "having Spirit" (得神) or "loss of Spirit" (失神)? What is your evidence?

PRE · Q2

What does her pale yellow, dull complexion suggest to you? Consider both the color and the "without brightness" quality separately.

PRE · Q3

Her lips are pale and her skin is dry. What single underlying substance deficiency could explain both findings together?

Post-Lecture Questions — Complete After Class

POST · Q1

Using proper TCM terminology, state Ms. Chen's complete observation-based differentiation (Shen status, color pattern, and appearance findings together).

POST · Q2

What additional inspection findings (e.g., tongue, sense-organ exam) would you now want to gather to confirm this pattern? What would change your differentiation if found?

POST · Q3

If left untreated, what appearance and color changes might signal further progression? What would a "poor prognosis" complexion look like by contrast with today's "good prognosis" description?

F · After-Lecture Synthesis & Self-Monitoring

Complete this section within 24 hours of lecture for maximum retention.

I Can Now Confidently...

Still Unclear — I Need to Review...

Connected to Other Learning...

Concept Map Completion — Five-Color Diagnosis

Complete the map using only what you can recall from lecture:

五色诊 Wǔ Sè Zhěn — Five-Color Diagnosis

红 Red	白 Pale (White)	黄 Yellow	青 Blue (Green)	黑 Dark (Black)
Heat (excess or deficiency)				
Case example / notes:	Case example / notes:	Case example / notes:	Case example / notes:	Case example / notes:

Homework Tracker

Assigned Homework (from lecture & syllabus):

☐ **Task 1:** Summarize the five colors of the face in a comparison table — columns for Face Color, Indications (TCM Terms), Case Example, and Remarks.

☐ **Task 2:** Read *Chinese Acupuncture & Moxibustion (CAM)*, Chapter 12, and *Foundations of Chinese Medicine (FCM)*, Chapter 23, before Week 7.

☐ **Task 3:** Continue Pulse/Tongue Journal entries per the course schedule.